

# CAROLINE SARKKI

Full-Stack Software Engineer | Developer Experience | San Francisco Bay Area | Remote-Friendly  
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## SUMMARY

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Full-Stack Software Engineer with 4 years of experience building scalable, accessible, cloud-ready applications across the entire stack. I work with React, Redux Toolkit, and TypeScript on the frontend and Node.js, Java, and Spring Boot on the backend, backed by MongoDB, PostgreSQL, and SQL and deployed through Docker, CI/CD, and Google Cloud Platform. At KQED I have delivered end-to-end features spanning modern UI architecture, REST API development, authentication workflows, real-time data integrations, and cloud deployment — including a Membership & Account platform rebuild, high-traffic election systems serving hundreds of thousands of users, and the team's first internal AI product: a Claude API-powered election results pipeline that replaced a dozen-person manual process with a self-serve internal tool, validated against live data during the June 2026 midterms and connecting to our public election results site this November. Alongside feature work I have driven the team's developer experience: I authored our API tooling standards and access model, built a shared AI skills repository, and created a workshop series that reached most of our 15-person product team. I care about accessibility, test coverage, and code that stays maintainable long after release.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Frontend:** React, Redux Toolkit, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Sass/SCSS, HTML5, CSS3, Responsive Design, Component Architecture, Accessibility (A11y), WCAG 2.1 AA, ARIA

**Backend:** Node.js, Java, Spring Boot, Express, REST APIs, API Design, Authentication (OAuth/JWT), Python

**Databases:** MongoDB, PostgreSQL, SQL

**Cloud & DevOps:** Docker, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Containerization, Cloud Deployments

**Testing:** Jest, React Testing Library, Unit Testing, Integration Testing, TDD

**AI & Emerging Tech:** Claude API, OpenAI API, LLM Integration, AI-Assisted Development (Claude Code, Cursor), Prompt Engineering, Web Scraping & Data Automation, Custom AI Skill Development, AI Chatbots, Recommendation Systems

**Developer Experience:** Internal Tooling, Technical Documentation, Developer Enablement, API Tooling (Postman), Role-Based Access Management, Workshop Design & Facilitation, Onboarding, Best-Practice Standards

**Leadership & Collaboration:** Technical Mentorship, Code Review, Architecture Discussions, Agile/Scrum, Cross-Functional Communication, Product Partnership

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Frontend Developer

June 2025 – Present

KQED · San Francisco, CA

*Full-stack scope: React and TypeScript frontends, Node.js/Java/Spring Boot APIs, MongoDB, and Docker/GCP deployment*

- Designed and built the team's first internal AI product: a self-serve election results pipeline where a data lead selects a county and uploads a results file or triggers an automated scrape, with the Claude API standardizing the output into sheet-ready data. Validated against live election data during the June 2026 midterms; connecting to KQED's public election results site for full production in November 2026.
- Replaced a manual process that required about a dozen people entering county results by hand with a self-serve tool run by a much smaller team repeatedly over the month-plus results period, while retaining human QA review.
- Delivered end-to-end development for a Membership & Account platform rebuild using React, TypeScript, Node.js, Java, Spring Boot, and MongoDB, contributing to increased donor activity at launch.
- Built backend APIs for authentication, profile management, and internal integrations, including secure user account deletion and integration with a third-party membership provider handling sensitive patron data.
- Established the team's Postman standard adopted by all engineers and contractors, authoring the documentation and a canonical, forkable collection pattern and configuring role-based access permissions.
- Created and taught an AI Maker Workshop series on practical AI and LLM tooling, attended by 10 of the 15 members of a cross-functional product team spanning engineering, design, and product management.
- Built and maintain a shared repository of reusable AI skills — authoring the first three for engineering documentation, Jira ticket formatting, and document summarization — open for contribution and use across the full 15-person product team, including non-engineers.

- Initiated and led technical discussions for the modernization of a core Media API, diagramming data flows and clarifying cross-team dependencies to support long-term architectural planning.
- Led early discovery and planning for a proposed Radio CMS refresh, coordinating with cross-functional stakeholders to assess technical viability and define requirements ahead of a go/no-go decision.
- Mentored 3 junior engineers and 4 interns, and regularly support non-technical teammates; contribute to architecture discussions and code review.

### Frontend Developer

June 2023 – June 2025

KQED · San Francisco, CA

- Engineered major features for Voter Guide and Election Results platforms serving hundreds of thousands of users during high-traffic election periods, including the 2024 U.S. Presidential Election and the LA Times–endorsed 2022 Midterm Guide.
- Developed scalable frontend architectures using React, Redux Toolkit, TypeScript, and Sass, integrating dynamic election APIs, real-time data feeds, and WordPress as a headless CMS.
- Rebuilt the global navigation system for improved accessibility, clarity, and performance.
- Supported the Youth Media platform's WCAG 2.1 AA accessibility certification through accessible, semantic component patterns.
- Redesigned banner ad components and enhanced ad delivery integration.
- Improved UI reliability and test coverage using Jest and React Testing Library.

### Junior Software Developer

June 2022 – June 2023

KQED · San Francisco, CA

- Implemented frontend and backend features using React, JavaScript, Python, and REST APIs.
- Contributed to foundational accessible UI patterns later adopted across multiple platforms.
- Improved documentation and test coverage through QA collaboration and code review.

## SELECTED PROJECTS

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Crittr — Full-stack platform featuring a custom OpenAI-powered chatbot and recommendation engine.

Additional AI-enhanced tools: a note-taking app with automated summaries, a content-aware Chrome extension, and an AI job-search assistant.

## VOLUNTEERING

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### Technical Instructor

Code Tenderloin

- Taught introductory JavaScript, HTML, and CSS to career-changing and first-time programmers.
- Led hands-on workshops covering foundational web development.
- Refined teaching materials and curriculum based on learner feedback.

## EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

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App Academy — Full-Stack Software Development

University of California, Davis — B.S., Human Development

Codecademy — AI Maker Bootcamp: Learn to Build with AI Tools (certificate)

## EARLIER EXPERIENCE

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Prior to transitioning into software engineering: Onboarding Contractor at Mercury (supported 1,000+ onboarding workflows); Tutor at Tutorfly; Rehab Aide at Select Physical Therapy; Optometric Assistant at Midtown Eyeworks; Service Representative at 24 Hour Fitness.